Three ways to show the same story

You've cleaned the data, run the stats, found the pattern. Now comes the decision that earns marks: which type of data visualisation do you actually build? The same numbers can become a tall scrolling infographic, a wall of posters, or a live dashboard — and picking the wrong one for the audience loses the message.

What this key knowledge covers
This summary distils everything you need for **KK15 — Three ways to show the same story** in Data Analysis. Work through the explanations, then use the worked good-vs-weak answers to see exactly how marks are won and lost. Tick off the revision checklist at the end before a SAC or exam.

Study summary

Same ingredients, three different dishes

Think of your dataset as a basket of ingredients. The **purpose** (KK14 — to inform, persuade, educate or entertain) is *why* you're cooking. The **components** (KK16 — charts, tables, text, graphics) are the *ingredients*. This dot point, KK15, is the **dish you serve** — the overall *form* the visualisation takes. Same eggs and flour can become a cake, a stack of pancakes, or a buffet of small plates. Choosing the dish is choosing the **type**.

Two questions decide the type almost every time. Slide each one in your head when a scenario lands:

A printed poster freezes the data the day you publish it. A dashboard can update as new data arrives and let the viewer filter and drill in. If the user needs to **interact** or the data **keeps changing**, you're heading toward a dashboard.

A long-form infographic is one cohesive story read top-to-bottom. A series of posters breaks the story into separate, self-contained pieces that can be spread across a space or shown one at a time. Need it to live as **independent chunks**? That's a poster series.

Read it — a long-form infographic you scroll or read down in one sitting. **Walk it** — a poster series you walk past, each poster a stop. **Watch it** — a dashboard you keep an eye on as the numbers change. If you can decide which verb fits the audience, you've picked the type.

Long-form infographic

A single, usually **tall, static** graphic that tells one complete story from top to bottom. It blends short text, statistics, icons, images and a few charts into one continuous flow. You meet these every day: the tall posts that fill your social feed, a "year in review", a public-health poster on a wall.

- › **One continuous narrative** — a clear start, middle and conclusion, read in order.
- › **Static** — fixed once published; the data doesn't update and the viewer can't filter it.
- › **Self-contained** — text, stats, images and charts together so it stands alone with no explanation.
- › **Tall layout** — usually vertical, designed to be scrolled or read down a single page.

Best when: you want to broadcast *one* message to a wide audience in a single hit — and you don't need them to interact. ScreenWise use: the student leaders build one tall "Where did our week go?" infographic to post on the school socials and show at assembly.

A series of infographic posters

Instead of one tall graphic, you split the story into a **set of separate posters**, each carrying one sub-theme or angle. They share a look and feel so they read as a family, but each poster works on its own. Think of a museum exhibit or a corridor campaign where each panel is its own stop.

- › **Modular** — a collection of standalone pieces, not one continuous scroll.
- › **One idea per poster** — each focuses on a single trend so it's digestible at a glance.
- › **Consistent style** — shared colours, fonts and layout tie the set together as one campaign.
- › **Spread across space or time** — displayed along a corridor, around a room, or as a slideshow.

Best when: the audience encounters the message in pieces, in different places or over several days, and you want each piece to land on its own. ScreenWise use: a "Digital Wellbeing Week" set — Monday's poster is total hours, Tuesday's is top apps, Wednesday's is the sleep link — one per day down the senior corridor.

Dashboard

A single screen that brings several views of the data together as **panels (or "widgets")** so you can monitor everything at a glance. Dashboards are usually **dynamic**: they refresh as new data arrives and let the viewer filter, switch date ranges or drill into detail. Think of a car's dashboard, a sports scoreboard, or the analytics screen behind a YouTube channel.

- › **Multiple coordinated panels** — several charts and key numbers tiled on one screen.
- › **At-a-glance monitoring** — designed to be scanned quickly and often, not read once.
- › **Dynamic & interactive** — updates with live data; viewers filter, sort and drill down.
- › **Audience of decision-makers** — built for someone who acts on the numbers regularly.

Best when: the data keeps arriving and a person needs to *track* it and make ongoing decisions. ScreenWise use: the wellbeing coordinator opens a dashboard that updates as more students submit — average hours, top apps, a sleep gauge — and filters by year level whenever she likes.

Pour the data into a different mould

Below is one dataset — the coloured blocks are the screen-time, app-usage, sleep and mood fields from ScreenWise. The numbers never change. Press a button and watch the *same blocks* reorganise into each type. That reshaping *is* KK15: one dataset, three visualisation types.

The three types, side by side

This table is your exam anchor. If a question asks you to compare two types or pick between them, every row here is a point of difference you can lean on.

The decision tool

Answer the two axis questions and the tool names the type — and, just as importantly, the *reason*. Exam answers that name a type without a reason cap out fast; the reason is where the marks live.

A fixed message split into standalone pieces suits a set of posters — one idea each, spread across a space.

Now sort the scenarios

Drag each brief into the type you'd recommend. They snap back if they're in the wrong bin — read the brief for the two clues (live-or-fixed, one-story-or-many).

The P·E·L writing trainer

Short-answer marks come from structure, not length. Use **P**oint → **E**xample → **L**ink. Click each step to build a full-mark answer to: "*The wellbeing coordinator wants to monitor screen-time results as surveys arrive. Recommend a type of data visualisation and justify your choice (3 marks).*"

VCE-style questions

Try each one yourself first. Then reveal the weak answer, the strong answer and the marking guide. Mark your own attempt — your score builds in the dock.

- 1 mark — long-form = single static graphic, one continuous narrative.
- 1 mark — dashboard = multiple panels, dynamic/interactive, for monitoring.
- A genuine point of difference is required, not just naming both.
- 1 mark — recommends a long-form infographic.
- 1 mark — feature-based justification (single, static, self-contained story).
- 1 mark — links the choice to the wide, one-time, shareable audience.
- 1 mark — describes the poster series (modular, standalone, one idea each).
- 1 mark — describes the long-form infographic (single continuous story).
- 1 mark — relates both to the corridor / five-day display context.
- 1 mark — states and justifies the poster-series choice.
- 1 mark — recommends a dashboard.
- 2 marks — justification: multiple coordinated panels, dynamic/updating, interactive filtering, tied to ongoing monitoring (1 each, max 2).
- 2 marks — explains the infographic is static/fixed and non-interactive, so it cannot show live updates or allow filtering (1 each, max 2).
- (a) 1 mark type + 1 mark justification (single static broadcast).
- (b) 1 mark type + 1 mark justification (modular, met in pieces).
- (c) 1 mark type + 1 mark justification (live, filterable monitoring).
- Justifications must link a feature of the type to that audience's need.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Identify / Name / State	Just give the correct type — one or two words. No reason needed.
Describe	Say what the type is and its key features (structure, static/dynamic).
Compare / Distinguish	Give points of difference between two types — use both sides.
Recommend / Select & justify	Pick a type, give reasons it fits the audience, and often why the other doesn't.
Explain why	Link a feature of the type directly to the audience's need.

Common traps & misconceptions

Exam trap

□ Dashboard ≠ "must be a computer screen" Most dashboards are digital and live, but the defining trait is **multiple coordinated views for monitoring**, not the device. Don't define a dashboard by saying "it's on a screen" — define it by what it does: pulls several panels together so you can watch the whole picture at once.

Exam trap

□ Confusing the *type* with the *purpose* KK14 is purpose (inform, persuade, educate, entertain). KK15 is the form (infographic, poster series, dashboard). "It informs the audience" answers the wrong dot point. Fix: name the form, then link it to the audience.

Exam trap

□ Calling everything "an infographic" A dashboard is not an infographic, and a poster series is not "one infographic". Use the precise term the study design uses. Fix: long-form infographic / series of infographic posters / dashboard — say which.

Exam trap

⚖ Naming a type but not justifying it "A dashboard" on its own is usually one mark of several. Examiners want **why this type suits the audience**. Fix: tie the choice to a feature — "live updates suit ongoing monitoring".

Exam trap

□ Forgetting to say why the *other* type is unsuitable "Select and justify" questions often need you to rule out the alternative too. A past exam awarded full marks only when students said why the rejected option didn't fit. Fix: add one line — "an infographic is static, so it can't show the live updates the coach needs".

Exam trap

□ Describing components instead of the type Listing "it has charts, a title and some text" describes KK16 components, not which type it is. Fix: describe the overall structure — tall single graphic vs. set of posters vs. tiled panels.

Exam trap
 Defining a dashboard by its device "It's on a computer" isn't the defining trait. Fix: define it by multiple coordinated panels for at-a-glance, ongoing monitoring.

How to answer exam questions

Read the **command word** first — it sets how much to write. *State/Identify* wants a word or phrase; *Describe* wants features; *Explain* wants reasons and links; *Justify/Evaluate* wants a judgement backed by evidence. Always pull in the **scenario detail** rather than answering in the abstract. The examples below contrast a weak response with a strong one for the same question.

Q1. Distinguish

Between a **long-form infographic** and a **dashboard** as types of data visualisation.

✗ A weak answer
A long-form infographic is an infographic and a dashboard is a dashboard. They both show data with charts and pictures. — Restates the names and lists a shared component (charts). No actual point of difference — 0 marks.

✓ A strong answer
A long-form infographic is a single, **static** graphic that presents one continuous story to be read top-to-bottom. A dashboard is a screen of **multiple coordinated panels** that is usually **dynamic and interactive**, letting the viewer monitor and filter data as it updates. — One clear difference on each side (static single story vs dynamic multi-panel). Full marks.

How the marks are awarded

- 1 mark — long-form = single static graphic, one continuous narrative.
- 1 mark — dashboard = multiple panels, dynamic/interactive, for monitoring.
- A genuine point of difference is required, not just naming both.

Q2. Recommend

The ScreenWise team wants to share their findings with the **whole school at assembly and on social media** as one memorable, shareable graphic. Recommend a type of data visualisation and justify your choice. ScreenWise: 180 senior students surveyed on weekly screen time, app use and sleep.

✗ A weak answer

They should use an infographic because infographics look good and people like them on social media. — Names a type but the justification is generic ("look good"). Doesn't link to the one-time, broadcast audience. ~1 mark.

✓ A strong answer

I recommend a **long-form infographic**. It tells the whole screen-time story in one tall, self-contained graphic the audience reads in a single pass, which suits a **broadcast, one-time** audience at assembly and a shareable social post. Because it is static and needs no interaction, it works equally well projected on a screen or shared as an image. — Names the type, justifies with its features (single static story, self-contained), and links directly to the broadcast/shareable audience. Full marks.

How the marks are awarded

- 1 mark — recommends a long-form infographic.
- 1 mark — feature-based justification (single, static, self-contained story).
- 1 mark — links the choice to the wide, one-time, shareable audience.

Q3. Compare

For "Digital Wellbeing Week", the school will display findings **along the senior corridor across five days**. **Compare** a series of infographic posters with a long-form infographic for this purpose, and state which you would choose.

✗ A weak answer

Posters are smaller and infographics are bigger. I would choose posters because there are five days. — Touches the "five days" clue but the comparison is shallow (size only) and the reasoning is thin. ~1–2 marks.

✓ A strong answer

A **series of infographic posters** is a set of standalone pieces, each carrying one idea, that can be spread out — ideal for a corridor where students pass a different poster each day. A **long-form infographic** packs the whole story into one tall graphic meant to be read in a single sitting, which doesn't suit a message encountered in pieces over five days and locations. I would choose the **poster series**: its modular, one-idea-per-poster structure matches a campaign spread across space and time. — Both sides compared on real features (modular standalone vs single continuous), tied to the corridor/five-day context, with a justified choice. Full marks.

How the marks are awarded

- 1 mark — describes the poster series (modular, standalone, one idea each).
- 1 mark — describes the long-form infographic (single continuous story).
- 1 mark — relates both to the corridor / five-day display context.
- 1 mark — states and justifies the poster-series choice.

Q4. Recommend

A senior basketball coach wants to **track the team's stats throughout the season** — updating after every game and filtering by player. Recommend the most suitable type of data visualisation. Justify your recommendation and explain why a long-form infographic would **not** be suitable. Courtside: the senior team's game-by-game scoring, rebounds and minutes.

✗ A weak answer

A dashboard, because dashboards are good for sport and have lots of charts on the screen. — Correct type but the justification is vague and there is no explanation of why the infographic fails. ~2 marks.

✓ A strong answer

I recommend a **dashboard**. A dashboard tiles several coordinated panels — points, rebounds and minutes — on one screen and is **dynamic**, so it can update after each game and let the coach **filter by player** and drill into trends. This suits ongoing, repeated monitoring across a season. A **long-form infographic would not be suitable** because it is **static**: once published it is fixed, so it cannot show new game data as it arrives, and it offers no interaction for the coach to filter by player. — Names the type, justifies with multiple panels + dynamic + filter linked to season-long monitoring, and explicitly rules out the infographic on the static/no-interaction grounds. Full marks.

How the marks are awarded

- 1 mark — recommends a dashboard.
- 2 marks — justification: multiple coordinated panels, dynamic/updating, interactive filtering, tied to ongoing monitoring (1 each, max 2).
- 2 marks — explains the infographic is static/fixed and non-interactive, so it cannot show live updates or allow filtering (1 each, max 2).